

A Star Fleet Battles™ Rule Proposal

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On still-developing colony worlds, competent medical assistance was usually in short supply, and actual doctors were in shorter supply still. While general cargo was typically the freighter captain's bread, his or her butter could often be specialty services that were difficult to come by. After all, anyone can haul plasma conduit from one place to another.

A medical skid allows a freighter to provide basic (and even some moderately-advanced) medical services to (paying) customers in places where there are few (if any) alternatives. Rarely staffed with highly experienced medical personnel, they would often rely on sophisticated medical expert systems to assist with diagnosis and treatment plans.

Typically, a skid of this type has an APR box, two lab boxes, two cargo boxes (for medical supplies) and a transporter; it would increase the freighter's BPV by six. The skid also adds a single crew unit (representing the medical staff). The healthcare facilities of the skid were often spartan, so there was little point to a Hospital Freighter (R1.61) (R1.62) adding one (although no technical barrier to doing so).

Some variations have a small shuttle bay, into which a standard administrative shuttle was shoehorned, instead of the transporter. These would increase the BPV of the freighter by seven.

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